developing India within a democratic framework has failed. (Indians will soon vote) in the fourth—and surely last—general election." Maxwell predicted that the Army would soon rule India.'

With the clarity of hindsight it is obvious that Prime Minister Nehru blundered on many counts, his biggest failing being the virtual destruction of his own military thanks to his deep-seated insecurities. From his infamous remark made immediately after Independence—'we do not need the military'—to a systematic downgrading of the Armed Forces in the evolving civil-military structure, Nehru played an active part in weakening the confidence and capability of the military. All this while, China's overtly expansionist moves were never challenged and despite the Rajputs at Nam Ka Chu, the Sikhs at Bum-la, the Garhwalis at Nuranang, the Jats and Gorkhas in DBO and Galwan and Srijap, the Kumaonis at Walong and Rezang-la, when the Chinese finally made their move, the Indian political and military leadership folded. When called upon to defend its own territory, despite the bravery and sacrifice of its junior officers and men, as a result of pathetic leadership and large-scale bungling, the army failed in its mission in battle after battle. 1962, quite simply, was the war that wasn't.